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NATION | P4

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NATION | P3

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UAE calls to protect Syria's unity, integrity

SYRIAN PARLIAMENT BACKS PEOPLE'S ASPIRATIONS FOR A BETTER FUTURE

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

The UAE is closely monitoring developments in Syria and has reaffirmed its commitment to the country's unity, territorial integrity, and the security of its people. In a statement, the Ministry of Foreign Affairs (MoFA) called on all parties to act wisely during this critical juncture to address the aspirations of all Syrians.

The Ministry also stressed the importance of preserving Syria's national institutions and preventing chaos or instability.

Transitional government

Meanwhile, Syrian television reported that the rebel group responsible for toppling President Bashar Al Assad has tasked Mohammad Al Bashir with forming a transitional government. Al Bashir, a trained engineer and leader of a quasi-administration established in 2017 by Hayat Tahrir Al Sham (HTS), will oversee the transition. The move followed a meeting between Al Bashir, HTS leader Ahmad Al Sharaa (Mo-

hammad Al Jolani), and current Prime Minister Ghazi Al Jalali.

Also yesterday, the Syrian parliament declared its support for the people's aspirations for a better future. It described December 8 as a historic day, emphasising the importance of building a new Syria founded on law and justice. State news agency SANA, now featuring the rebel flag on its Telegram account, echoed these sentiments.

At The Hague, the UN's chemical watchdog, OPCW, urged Syrian authorities to secure suspected stockpiles of chemical weapons. It stressed the need to prioritise the safety of chemical materials and related facilities amid the country's shifting power dynamics. Israeli Foreign Minister Gideon Saar said that his country had struck "chemical weapons" in Syria.

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At The Hague, the UN's chemical watchdog, OPCW, urged Syrian authorities to secure suspected stockpiles of chemical weapons.



Courtesy: UAE Presidential Court

MOHAMMAD BIN ZAYED RECEIVES STARMER

President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan yesterday welcomed Keir Starmer, Prime Minister of UK, who was on a working visit to the UAE. During their meeting at Qasr Al Shati in Abu Dhabi, Shaikh Mohammad and Starmer reviewed areas of bilateral collaboration and explored ways to enhance these ties, with the aim of advancing the development ambitions of both countries and their peoples.

SEE ALSO P5

New tax for UAE multinational firms

MNEs need to pay 15% tax on profits in each country they operate in

DUBAI

BY MANOJ NAIR
Business Editor

In a major update to corporate tax norms, a new 'domestic minimum top-up tax' (DMTT) will now apply to multinational enterprises (MNEs) in the UAE, which also comes with new tax incentives

for research and development for the global firms.

The tax is part of the UAE's adoption of the OECD's global tax standards, which require MNEs to pay a minimum effective tax rate of 15 per cent on profits in each country they operate in.

Applicable from Jan 1, 2025

The DMTT will apply from January 1, 2025, to multinational enterprises (MNEs) with global revenues of €750 million or more in at least

two of the past four years. Aimed at boosting innovation, the R&D incentive will offer a tax credit of 30-50 per cent on eligible expenditures for businesses conducting qualifying R&D activities in the UAE.

To encourage businesses to hire key employees (e.g., senior executives), a refundable tax credit will be available. This incentive will apply to salary costs for employees engaged in high-value activities that contribute to the UAE economy.

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